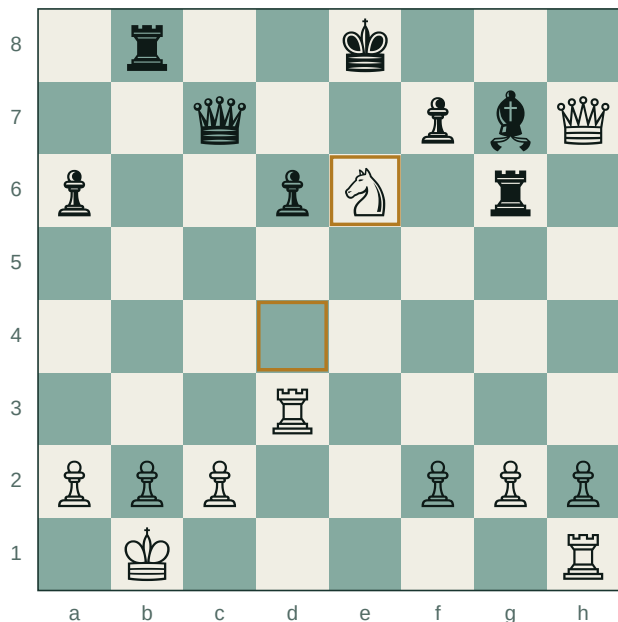


# Double checks: Black, move 20

Double checks

Black to move



Previous move: 20.Nxe6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**20...Rxb2+ 21. Ka1 Rxa2+ 22. Kxa2 Qxc2+**

**20...Rxb2+** Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on b2. Recorded reply: **21.Ka1**.

**21...Rxa2+** Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the bishop on g7 attacks the king on a1. Recorded reply: **22.Kxa2**.

**22...Qxc2+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From c2 it attacks king on a2 and rook on d3.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -2: the balance goes from -3 to -5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on b1. Absolute pin: pawn on b2.